The 6:15

MONDAY · NOVEMBER 2, 2026 NO. 35

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Today	Palantir Q3 after close, consensus EPS $0.35-$0.37 on ~$2.00-2.18B rev. (co. guided $2.160-2.164B) **[est. range, sources split]**; Knicks host Brooklyn, 7:30p ET, record still unconfirmed.
Tue 11/3	Midterm elections — House & Senate majorities in play. JOLTS, 10:00a ET. Pfizer before open, cons. $16.13B rev./$0.72 EPS (Zacks). AMD **[date inferred, not officially confirmed]**, cons. ~$13.0B rev.
Thu 11/5	Initial jobless claims, 8:30a ET (last confirmed print: 199k, wk. of 10/10 — three weeks stale this run).
Fri 11/6	October jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET — on track, no shutdown delay; Sept. print was +29k payrolls / 4.2% unemployment.
Sat 11/29	OPEC+ full ministerial meeting — sets 2027 policy; capacity review outstanding.

Frontier AI model releases and VC mega-rounds this week not verified to this brief's confidence bar — sources conflict on specific model names/dates — and are omitted rather than padded. No rocket launch confirmed for this window.

METRICS · PRE-MARKET GLOBEX/FX, ~5:10-5:20A ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	$108.45 (-4.39%) / $99.61 (-4.33%), Yahoo Finance front-month, 5:10a ET **[other feeds show -1.4% to -2.5%, wide overnight divergence — see Lead]**. Spread ~$8.84.
10Y UST	4.929% — Friday's close carried forward; cash market not yet open. 2Y/30Y **not confirmed this run**.
DXY	101.60 (-0.27%), 5:10a ET.
S&P / Nasdaq futures	7,652.5 (+0.51%) / 28,780.0 (+0.86%), 5:10a ET.

VIX	18.89 (-2.73%), 5:05a ET **[cash index, thin pre-open print]**; Friday's close was 19.42.
Gold	$3,905.90 (+0.18%), 5:10a ET.
Asia / Europe closes	**not confirmed this run**.
Retail gas (AAA)	$4.1694/gal national avg., as of 11/2 — down from $4.1837 (10/31), continuing decline.

Oil figures are live Globex trading, not a settle — ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI haven't posted a front-month settle yet this morning. Investing.com and FXStreet-sourced snapshots overnight ran $110.63-$111.84 on Brent depending on exact minute; this brief's number is Yahoo Finance's 5:10a ET real-time quote, flagged rather than reconciled.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, 02 NOV 2026, 1020Z (5:20A ET)

Status	Closed to commercial shipping, Day 246.
Transits	Still 2 vessels on Oct. 25 (IMF PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — unrevised, now 8 days stale **[flag]**.
Dark tankers, 24h	39 of 133 screened (29.3%), down from yesterday's 40.8% — screened pool again smaller than its own 7-day baseline.
War-risk premium	~32.0x pre-crisis, an Oct. 7 trade-press estimate, now 26 days stale — background only.
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±9 (Extreme, flat 24h); Escalation Forecast 59±11 (Elevated, flat 24h).

Methodology note: PortWatch counts only AIS-broadcasting crossings and likely understates true flow; the dark-tanker screen measures AIS silence, not interdiction, against a shrinking screened pool; the war-risk figure is a single, stale trade-press estimate. None of the three is additive with another.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over. Reported (not confirmed) qualifying offer to Bednar remains unconfirmed by club/MLB.
Knicks	Record still unreconciled **[continuity]**. Host Brooklyn tonight, 7:30p ET.
Northwestern	No reported moves in the last 24 hours; next game date not confirmed this run.

LEAD

OIL, IRAN, THE ELECTION

Crude gives back Friday's war premium as Trump signals more patience with Iran, two days before voters decide how much patience he gets

Oil did Friday's move in reverse. Brent front-month traded at $108.45 as of 5:10a ET Monday, down 4.39% on Yahoo Finance's real-time quote — other overnight snapshots from FXStreet and Investing.com-sourced wires put the retreat anywhere from 1.4% to 2.5% depending on the minute sampled, a spread wide enough that this brief won't pick one, but every feed agrees on direction. [fact, NEW] WTI fell in step, to $99.61 (-4.33%, Yahoo). Both grades are unwinding Friday's rebound — Brent $113.43, WTI $104.12 — which itself had been a flight-to-safety bid as equities took their worst week since June. [fact, continuity] The mechanism: a Reuters-reported signal that President Trump wants to give Iran diplomacy more room before any resumption of strikes, now explicitly framed around not acting before Tuesday's midterms. [fact, NEW] That's a continuation, not a reversal, of the position he's held since an Oct. 8 social-media post ruling out strikes before Election Day — but markets had spent Friday pricing in the opposite tail risk, that a hard post-election turn was coming, and Monday's move unwinds some of that premium. [read]

OPEC+ gave the market a second, calmer data point Sunday: the seven core members holding spare capacity — Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Algeria, Kazakhstan and Oman — kept December targets unchanged at roughly 31 million bpd, a third straight monthly pause, with the group's next and more consequential decision (full 2027 policy) pushed to a Nov. 29 ministerial. [fact, NEW] That resolves this brief's Sunday [DEVELOPING] flag with the least newsworthy outcome available: no change. The country-level targets, per

OPEC's own table: Saudi Arabia 10.478 million bpd, Russia 9.949 million, Iraq 4.431 million, Kuwait 2.676 million, Kazakhstan 1.628 million, Algeria 1.007 million, Oman 841,000 — a joint target of roughly 31 million bpd, unchanged for a third straight month, after the group finished unwinding 1.65 million bpd of 2023-vintage voluntary cuts back in September. [fact, NEW] The pause itself is a tell — Gulf members with notionally higher quotas aren't using them, which several analysts interviewed by wire services attribute to output still constrained by the Iran war rather than voluntary restraint. [read, attributed] A capacity review the group says is still underway, covering roughly 2 million bpd of cuts that run through year-end, is the thing to watch into the Nov. 29 meeting.

Second-order consequences split two ways. For the Fed, cheaper crude Monday morning works against the inflation-upside case hawks were building after Friday's selloff, at the margin making a December cut easier to justify — though this brief isn't pricing that from one morning's futures move. For the election itself, the read is narrower: a $4-plus oil move two days out doesn't change any race, but it does strip away one low-information signal (rising pump prices as a drag on incumbent-party sentiment) that campaigns on both sides had been citing. AAA's national average has in fact been falling for a week — $4.1694/gal today, down from $4.1837 Friday — which undercuts the gas-price-as-election-issue framing more than Monday's crude futures move does on its own. [fact, NEW]

Equities read the same morning differently: S&P futures +0.51%, Nasdaq futures +0.86%, VIX down to 18.89 from Friday's 19.42 — a risk-on tape that looks like relief at both the Iran de-escalation signal and OPEC+'s non-event, layered on top of a market that sold off hard enough Friday (Nasdaq's worst month since March) to have

room to bounce. [fact, NEW] That bounce is landing on top of, not instead of, this week's other catalysts: Palantir reports hours from now, Pfizer and (probably) AMD report Tuesday, JOLTS prints Tuesday morning, and polls close Tuesday night — four potential volatility events stacked inside 36 hours, which is its own reason a reflexive Monday-morning rally shouldn't be read as a settled verdict on any of them. [read] Watch: whether Monday's cash open confirms the futures move or fades it; whether any Trump administration figure confirms or walks back the Reuters diplomacy signal before polls open Tuesday; and whether Friday's $113 Brent print was the cycle high or just the latest one, given Iran's war-risk premium (last priced 26 days ago at 32x normal) hasn't actually been repriced by anyone this week.

POLITICS

Congress defused its own pre-election risk last week: Trump signed a stopgap funding bill — passed by the House and already cleared by the Senate — that keeps the government open through Dec. 11, 2026, averting a shutdown two days before voters go to the polls. [fact, NEW] That punts, rather than resolves, the fight over all twelve FY2027 appropriations bills, none of which Congress has finished; the real negotiation starts in a lame-duck session after Tuesday. [fact, NEW] Separately, early voting has broken the modern midterm record: the University of Florida's Election Lab counted 48.5 million ballots cast as of Sunday afternoon, above 2022's 45.9 million full-cycle mark with a day of early voting still to go in some states; a Reuters-sourced count ran about 600,000 lower at a slightly earlier timestamp, which this brief reads as a sampling-time gap, not a real disagreement. [fact, NEW] Texas (6.86M) and California (5.06M) lead state totals; in states that record party registration,

Democrats are again over-represented relative to their share of registered voters, continuing the pattern this brief flagged Sunday. Georgia, Florida, Arizona and Illinois also posted unusually high totals; Georgia's first early-voting day alone ran more than 55,000 ballots ahead of the state's first day in the 2022 midterm, and Dallas County surpassed its own presidential-year early turnout on day one. [fact, NEW] The generic-ballot and approval numbers themselves are unchanged from issue No. 34 and aren't re-run here. One more thing the funding bill sets up: none of the twelve individual FY2027 appropriations bills has cleared Congress, so the Dec. 11 deadline hands whoever wins Tuesday's elections a lame-duck session in which the outgoing Congress, not the incoming one, writes the next funding fight — a dynamic that applies whether government divides or doesn't.

ECONOMICS

The data calendar resumes after a quiet weekend. JOLTS job openings post Tuesday at 10:00a ET — the first hard labor-demand read since September's report (released Oct. 2, +29k payrolls, 4.2% unemployment). [fact, context] Initial claims follow Thursday; the only confirmed recent print this brief holds is 199,000 for the week of Oct. 10, now three weeks stale, so Thursday's number carries more information than usual. [fact, flag] The real event is Friday: October's nonfarm payrolls report is on track for its scheduled 8:30a ET release with no shutdown-driven delay, this brief confirms, which matters only because the precedent exists — the 2025 shutdown forced BLS to cancel a monthly report outright, and a brief January 2026 lapse pushed one release back five days. [fact, NEW] None of that risk is live this week with the funding bill in place, which is itself the reason this Friday's print should be treated as

clean data rather than the start of another collection gap. For a reader positioning around it: September's +29k print and 4.2% unemployment rate are the base case Friday revises, not confirms — a labor market still adding jobs, but at a pace soft enough that one weak revision either way moves the December rate-cut debate materially. Tuesday's JOLTS release matters less for the headline openings count than for its quits and hires sub-series, which tend to lead payrolls by a month or two — a fresh read on labor-market momentum going into Friday's report, independent of whatever the topline openings number does.

BUSINESS

This week's earnings calendar firmed up overnight. Palantir reports today after the close — confirmed, where Sunday's issue carried it as unconfirmed by one tracker — with consensus clustered at $0.35-$0.37 EPS on roughly $2.00-$2.18B revenue; the company's own guide of $2.160-2.164B sits inside that range. [fact, NEW] Options markets have been implying a roughly ±12% move around the print, per this brief's Sunday issue — a figure not re-verified today but consistent with how the stock has traded around its last several reports. Tuesday brings two more: Pfizer reports before the open, confirmed, with Zacks consensus at $16.13B revenue and $0.72 EPS; AMD's date remains the softer of the three — one tracker infers Tuesday after market close, but calls it unconfirmed, and consensus revenue estimates cluster near $13.0B (+41% y/y per one estimate) with EPS estimates split sharply between a GAAP read near $1.42 and a non-GAAP read near $1.87, a gap wide enough that this brief won't treat either as the number to beat without more confirmation. [fact, flag] All three prints land before Tuesday's polls close, which is its own small irony: the week's most concrete catalysts are

corporate, not electoral, even as the electoral one dominates the calendar.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The Lead covers the diplomacy signal driving this morning's oil move; the Board's straits.live read adds the on-the-water texture. The dark-tanker share fell to 29.3% of 133 screened vessels over the past 24 hours (5:20a ET), down from Sunday's 40.8% of 142 — directionally consistent with a de-escalation signal, though straits.live again flags its screened pool as running below its own 7-day baseline, which this brief reads as a measurement artifact as much as a behavioral one. [read, continuity] PortWatch's transit count is now eight days frozen at 2 vessels against an 85/day pre-crisis baseline, the longest unrevised stretch this brief has carried — either genuinely nothing is transiting, or the tracker itself has a reporting gap, and there's no way to distinguish the two from this feed alone. [fact, flag] Crisis Pressure held flat at 88 (Extreme) and Escalation Forecast flat at 59 (Elevated) for a second straight day. No new IRGC claim, UKMTO advisory, or Iranian diplomatic statement surfaced in this run's research; Araghchi's Oct. 18 conditional reopening offer remains unanswered as far as this brief can confirm. Day 246 of a closure this brief has now tracked for most of a year is itself a data point: insurers haven't moved the war-risk multiple in 26 days, which this brief reads as the market having already priced in an indefinite closure rather than genuine calm, not as a signal that risk has actually fallen. The gap between that stale insurance pricing and this morning's sharp oil-futures move is worth watching — if Monday's crude selloff holds through a real settle, war-risk premia that haven't repriced since Oct. 7 are the next number due for a revision, in either direction depending on what, if anything, comes out of Washington or Tehran before Tuesday's vote.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over (eliminated Oct. 7). No new transaction news.
Knicks	Host Brooklyn tonight, 7:30p ET. Record unconfirmed this run — unresolved since issue No. 33.
Northwestern	Lost 34-14 at Oregon Saturday (continuity). Next game not confirmed this run.

Continuity. Technology and Geopolitics are dark this issue — nothing beyond Friday's already-reported Intel/Amazon/Reddit earnings story (Technology) or the Iran diplomacy signal already in the Lead (Geopolitics) was verified this run, so neither section is padded with re-adjectived material. Generic-ballot and Trump-approval figures are unchanged from issue No. 34 and not re-run.

Unverified figures flagged this issue: the precise overnight Brent/WTI move (sources split 1.4%-4.4%); AMD's earnings date and which EPS basis (GAAP vs. non-GAAP) applies; the Knicks' win-loss record (unresolved since issue No. 33); Asia/Europe index closes; 2Y/30Y Treasury yields. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.